

DBS Group (DBSM.SI): First Take: 2Q25 slightly above GSe on lower CoC & better NIMs; 2025 guidance unchanged

DBS posted 2Q25 net profit of S\$2,824mn, +3% yoy/-3% qoq, +4% vs GSe. This quarter's numbers were driven by **(1) Lower than expected CoC at 12bps**, with the NPL ratio falling to 1.0% from 1.1% with slightly higher NPL formation offset by higher write-offs; **(2) NII ahead of GSe** at -1% qoq with **NIMs coming in better than expected at 2.05% (-7bps qoq)** at group though commercial book NIMs were down 13bps; **(3) Loan growth up +1% qoq on ccy**; **(4) Opex in line and well-controlled** with CIR at 39.6%. These, however, were slightly offset by **(5) Non-NII weaker vs GSe** on **softer fee income, -8% qoq**, on lower WM/loan-related/transaction fees. **Other non-NII also fell -3% qoq**, on lower treasury customer income. DBS will pay a total of 75cents of dividends for 2Q25 comprising 60cents of ordinary dividend and 15 cents of capital return dividend.

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DBS affirmed its 2025 outlook with: (1) NII to be slightly above 2024 level (unchanged) despite lower SORA and HIBOR with the impact of lower rates offset by proactive hedging and strong deposit growth; **(2) Commercial book non-NII growth at mid to high single digit (unchanged)** and WM at double digit growth; **(3) CIR to be low 40% (unchanged)**; **(4) SP to normalise to 17-20bps (unchanged)** and **GP reserves to provide a buffer (unchanged)**; **(5) Net profit to be below the 2024 level due to global min tax of 15% (unchanged).**

A decent set of results in our view with robust NII as NIMs were better than expected and asset quality benign. Furthermore, management's outlook was maintained. That said, slightly disappointing is the fall in WM fees though we note 1Q25 was an all time high. We expect DBS shares to hold up well. DBS will be holding a media briefing at 10.30am local time today, followed by an analyst briefing.

Key highlights:

- **Net interest income was 4% higher than GSe**, -1% qoq/ +2% yoy. Loan growth on a constant currency basis was +1% qoq / +4% yoy, underpinned by broad based growth in non-trade corporate loans, offsetting a decline in trade loans.
- **NIM -7bps qoq to 2.05% vs GSe of 2.00%**, as higher market trading income partly offset a 13bps qoq decline in commercial book NIM.
- **Non-interest income was slightly lower than GSe**, -6% qoq / +10% yoy. Fees

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and commission income was +11% yoy / -8% qoq, with wealth management fees weaker qoq though 1Q25 was a record level. Other non-interest income was +9% yoy / -3% qoq from lower customer treasury fees.

- **NPL ratio was lower at 1.0%** from 1.1% in 1Q25, with higher write-offs offsetting higher new NPL formation on the IBG book, and NPA on the CBG book was stable.
- **Credit cost came in at 12bps**, lower than GSe of 20bps, including 15bps of SP and 3bps release of GP. LLR remained flat qoq at 137%.
- **Expenses were +5% yoy/ +3% qoq, inline with GSe.** Expenses were well-managed with cost to income ratio (CIR) for the quarter at 39.6%, flat vs. 2Q24's 39.6%.

Our 12-month target price (2-staged DDM-based) for DBS is S\$54.50. Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration in rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Mismanaged top management transition. Remain Buy.

Exhibit 1: 2025 earnings summary

Income statement (\$mn)	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	2Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net Interest Income	3,594	3,597	3,728	3,681	3,648	2	(1)	3,519	4
Fee & Commission	1,048	1,109	968	1,275	1,167	11	(8)	1,234	(5)
Other Non-Interest Income	840	1,047	809	949	917	9	(3)	896	2
Non-Interest Income	1,888	2,156	1,777	2,224	2,084	10	(6)	2,130	(2)
Operating Income	5,482	5,753	5,505	5,905	5,732	5	(3)	5,643	2
Operating Expenses	(2,172)	(2,249)	(2,395)	(2,214)	(2,270)	5	3	(2,279)	(0)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	3,310	3,504	3,110	3,691	3,462	5	(6)	3,363	3
Loan Loss Provisions	(148)	(130)	(209)	(325)	(133)	(10)	(59)	(227)	(41)
Pre-tax Profit	3,213	3,440	2,960	3,437	3,388	5	(1)	3,218	5
Net Profit	2,733	3,027	2,523	2,897	2,824	3	(3)	2,727	4
Core Net Profit	2,752	3,027	2,623	2,897	2,824	3	(3)	2,727	4

Balance sheet (\$mn)	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	2Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Assets	790,111	789,609	827,219	840,823	841,896	7	0	848,572	(1)
Gross Loans	430,912	424,000	436,684	442,000	439,100	1.9	(0.7)	446,330	(2)
Non-Performing Loans	4,754	4,240	4,780	4,862	4,997	5	3	4,997	-
Customer Deposits	551,088	544,961	561,730	575,663	573,965	4	(0)	583,189	(2)

CAMEL Ratios (%)	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	2Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Core Tier 1	14.8	15.2	15.1	15.2	15.1			14.8	
NPL Ratio	1.10	1.00	1.09	1.10	1.00			1.12	
Loan Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	14	12	19	30	12			20	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.14	2.11	2.15	2.12	2.05			2.00	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	39.6	39.1	43.5	37.5	39.6			40.4	
Loan-to-Deposits	78.2	77.8	77.7	76.8	76.5			76.5	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

DBSM.SI	12m Price Target: S\$54.50	Price: S\$48.85	Upside: 11.6%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
	Market cap: S\$137.9bn / \$107.0bn	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E	
	3m ADTV: S\$203.1mn / \$157.9mn	11,409.0	10,361.6	10,799.4	11,346.3	
	Singapore	EPS (S\$)	4.01	3.67	3.86	4.08
	Asean Financials	EPS growth (%)	10.9	(8.4)	5.0	5.8
	M&A Rank: 3	P/E (X)	8.9	13.3	12.7	12.0
		P/B (X)	1.5	2.1	2.0	2.0
		ROA (%)	1.5	1.2	1.2	1.3
		ROE (%)	18.1	15.6	16.2	16.8
		Price/PPOP (X)	10.3	10.6	10.3	9.8
		Dividend yield (%)	6.2	6.3	6.8	7.2
			3/25	6/25E	9/25E	12/25E
	EPS (S\$)	1.02	0.96	0.88	0.79	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 6 Aug 2025 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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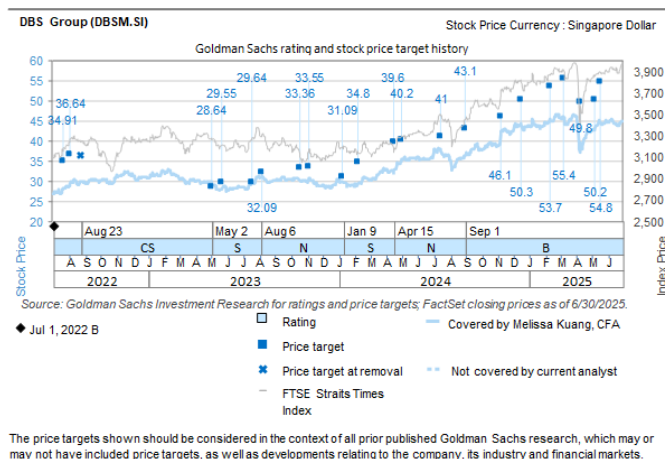
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